

Cats turn attention toward ASU

By CORKY SIMPSON
Citizen Sportswriter

Now that Texas-El Paso has played its annual practical joke on them, the Arizona Wildcats get ready this week for winners' bracket competition in the Western Athletic Conference's Southern Division baseball race.

UA and Arizona State (the winners' bracket) meet in a three-game set Thursday, Friday and Saturday nights at Packard Stadium in Tempe.

After an 11-4 embarrassment in the first game of a day-night double-header Saturday at Wildcat Field, Arizona trails ASU in the conference race by one game. The Sun Devils, who swept three from New Mexico, are 6-0 and Arizona, which won two of three from Texas-El Paso, is 5-1.

Left-hander Bob Chaulk struck out 10 and beat UTEP, 7-3, in Saturday's second game and "made the world look a whole lot better," in the words of UA coach Jerry Kindall.

The Miners ambushed Arizona in both games of a double-header last season in El Paso in what Kindall called "the bleakest day of my baseball career."

This time around, it was 16 singles and four Arizona errors that brought the Wildcats down.

But the Arizona team doesn't feel the upset will hurt in overcoming Arizona State.

"It always comes down to us and them," explained second baseman Les Pearsey, who hit his 10th homer of the season in Saturday's finale. "We have to beat ASU four out of six for the season, no matter how you look at it."

Kindall agreed that the UTEP loss wouldn't hurt. "We're not running out of games," he said. "This is only the second weekend of the season. Sure, it was a disappointment to lose, but we have plenty of games left."

Kindall indicated he will use his regular rotation

against the Sun Devils this week, meaning Craig Chamberlain (8-0) will open the series Thursday night, followed by Dave Crutcher (8-4) Friday and Chaulk (5-0) Saturday.

Pearsey, who now has 27 career homers at UA — one shy of Dennis Haines' all-time mark — says the ASU series is "always the most fun of the year."

"Both teams have a lot of support at these games and both teams are fired up."

The second sacker, now hitting .378 (second best on the team) rates Arizona an edge over the Sun Devils, on the strength of better pitching and overall defense.

"They have more power, more long ball hitters," he said. "And in team speed, we're about even. But we have the advantage in pitching and fielding."

In two meetings this season, both in the Best in the West Tournament, Arizona State prevailed, 8-1 and 7-4. Crutcher, a right-hander who suffered Saturday's loss to Texas-El Paso, was the loser in both contests against Arizona State.

UA has lost seven in a row to Arizona State, dating back to the first time the two teams met a year ago, when Arizona won, 9-6.

Texas-El Paso coach Andy Cohen disagrees with Pearsey's assessment and says Arizona State has "a much better all-around club."

"Both teams have power," Cohen said. "But ASU has an edge in pitching. We knocked out Crutcher and he's about the best Arizona has, so you'd have to give ASU the edge there."

Kindall's pitching staff holds the key to taking the series at Tempe. "We'll have to stop their hitters," he said. "We have to have good pitching."

"But we've got a good enough team to beat ASU. We simply have to play our best."

Pearsey drove a low, inside fastball over the left field fence in the second inning of Saturday night's game for No. 10 this season. The Wildcat second baseman had three RBIs for the game.

In the afternoon loss, first baseman Bob Woodside hit his fourth home run, a towering shot to left.

WILDCAT NOTES — Third baseman Brad Mills of UA was 4-for-10 in the Texas-

El Paso series and continues to lead the Wildcats in hitting with a .417 average... Pearsey, who went 4-for-13, is hitting .378 and freshman Terry Francona, 4-for-13 against the Miners, is batting .335... UTEP outfielder Danny Haygood suffered a third-degree shoulder separation in the bottom of the sixth Saturday night, when he fell after making a sensational running catch on a foul ball by Woodside. "I'll proba-

bly have to have it operated on," Haygood said. "It hurts like the dickens"... Attendance for the three-game set with the Miners totaled 4,410, bringing the season total at Wildcat Field to 35,373 — an average of 1,474 fans per game... Designated hitter Dan Feagler of UTEP was ejected from Saturday night's game for arguing with an umpire.

Miners 11, Wildcats 7									
First Game									
UTEP	ab	r	b	e	r	b	h	bb	so
Bravo	2b	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Cramer	3b	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Alsup	cf	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feagler	dh	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Cordy	dh	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Bratt	1b	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Walker	1b	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Flors	c	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Hildred	cf	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Haygood	lf	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Perez	rf	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
MMH	ss	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	44	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

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Haygood	lf	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Perez	rf	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
MMH	ss	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	44	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Wildcats 7, Miners 3									
Second Game									
UTEP	ab	r	b	e	r	b	h	bb	so
Bravo	2b	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Cramer	3b	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Alsup	cf	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feagler	dh	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
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Feagler	dh	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Cordy	dh	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Bratt	1b	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
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UA thinclads prove victory was no fluke

Special to the Citizen

TEMPE — The University of Arizona track team showed that its 89½-64½ dual-meet victory over defending national champion Arizona State earlier this season was no surprise or fluke.

The Wildcats, decimated by injuries right now, still managed to defeat the Sun Devils on ASU's home track, 80-70, Saturday night in UA's final dual meet of the season. Arizona, however, didn't have enough strength to capture triangular honors as ASU won with 74 points, followed by Arizona, 71, and Northern Arizona, 46.

The Cats were missing their top two sprinters, Dwayne Strozier and Elijah Jefferson, plus 7-2 high jumper James Frazier and against Arizona State that figured to be enough to swing the meet to the Sun Devils.

But the Devils weren't figuring on the performance

pointing to UA distance star Thom Hunt who hoped to run under four minutes for the first time in his career. He clocked 60 seconds for each of the first three laps but couldn't put on the necessary burst of speed for the last lap and finished third in 4:05.1.

Hunt also finished second in the 5,000 meters as teammate David Shoots finished first in 14:12.8.

The Wildcats also took sweeps in both hurdles events. Freshman David Still won the 110-meter highs in 14.18 with Ron Kennedy coming in second. Kennedy then won the 400-meter intermediates with a time of 52.75, still finishing second.

Some sort of award should go to Arizona junior Steve Jacobs. To aid the UA effort, Jacobs, a fine decathlete, competed in six events and won one, the javelin. He also competed in the 400 and 1,600 meter relays, the pole vault, the long jump and discus.

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Jaeckel's Lietzke beate

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Jaeckel defeated 1977 Tucson Open champion Bruce Lietzke yesterday in the first hole of a sudden-death playoff after making up six strokes on the final nine holes.

"On the eighth green, I looked at the scoreboard and saw how far behind the leaders I was," said Jaeckel, whose best finish this year was a fourth in Los Angeles. "I figured I was looking at a third place check, at best."

The 29-year-old Jaeckel picked up five strokes on the first five holes of the back nine with four birdies and an eagle and then tied Lietzke on the 18th hole with a birdie after Lietzke suffered a bogey.

In the streak, he holed out a 45-yard chip shot on No. 10 for a birdie, sank a 15-foot putt on No. 11 for another birdie and then parred No. 12 after burying the ball in a bunker and having to blast out to eight feet.

On the 560-yard par-5 13th hole, Jaeckel sank a sand wedge from 92 yards away to a green he couldn't see for

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x-B. Jaeckel	\$16,000	70-67-71-65	273	R					
Bruce Lietzke	\$9,120	69-66-66-70	273	P					
B. Wadkins	\$4,720	71-69-65-70	274	D					
Jim Nelford	\$4,720	69-67-72-69	274	B					
Ed Dougherty	\$3,280	69-68-74-65	276	J					
W. McCulloch	\$2,560	72-67-68-70	278	B					
Gary Koch	\$2,090	72-69-69-69	279	P					
Mike Walters	\$2,090	72-67-71-69	279	L					
Bob Murphy	\$2,090	72-66-72-71	279	C					
Allen Miller	\$2,090	71-69-73-71	279	J					
F. Molina	\$1,600	71-69-73-69	280	S					
Tom Shaw	\$1,400	67-72-74-68	280	C					
Ed Fiori	\$1,320	72-69-71-69	281	A					
W. Blackburn	\$1,320	69-72-69-71	281	D					
Bunky Henry	\$1,320	70-71-73-68	282	C					
Larry Nelson	\$1,320	69-69-61-74	282	J					
Al Kelley	\$865	71-70-70-71	282	T					
Sammy Rachels	\$865	68-74-70-73	282	B					
Jack Renner	\$865	69-72-71-69	282	C					
Mark Lyle	\$865	68-72-73-69	282	N					
Rik Massengale	\$865	69-69-71-73	282	P					
Bob Zender	\$865	70-68-73-70	282	L					
Frank Conner	\$604	68-73-71-71	283	S					
Gary Groh	\$604	68-73-71-71	283	J					
Mike Shea	\$604	68-72-73-70	283	C					
Bob Eastwood	\$604	72-71-71-69	283	B					
Tim Simpson	\$508	71-70-72-71	284	P					
Ron Streck	\$508	72-69-68-74	284	A					
Jeff Mitchell	\$508	71-71-74-68	284	T					